

Primary Source Annotation 2: Factory Testimony

Due: Friday, September 18 at 11:59 PM

Value: 30 points

Format: 600-word primary-source annotation

Purpose

Evaluate testimony about industrial labor as both evidence of working conditions and a product of the setting in which it was recorded.

Your task

- Choose one testimony from the 1832 British Sadler Committee, a Lowell mill worker account, or an early Meiji textile-worker recollection in the course sourcebook.
- Reconstruct who asked the questions, who answered, and what institutional purpose the record served.
- Analyze two concrete details about time, discipline, injury, household economy, or worker agency.
- Explain what the testimony reveals that production statistics cannot, and what it cannot establish about typical conditions.

Required sources or materials

- HIST 115 Digital Sourcebook, Unit 2
- Library guide: testimony as historical evidence

Submit

- 600-word annotation PDF with one short quotation and Chicago citation.

Grading criteria

Criterion	Pts	Full-credit evidence
Context	7	Accurately situates creator, audience, place, and historical moment.
Close reading	9	Analyzes two specific features of the source with careful evidence.
Interpretation	8	Makes a defensible claim and distinguishes inference from fact.
Limits and citation	6	Names silences or limits and supplies a complete Chicago citation.

Submission standards

Upload a readable PDF unless the handout specifies another format. Include your name, course code, and assignment title. Cite borrowed ideas and retain the editable source file. The learning portal timestamp is the official submission time.